

# Yue Cao

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## Employment

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**Syracuse University**, Syracuse, NY *2024 Aug - Present*  
**Assistant Teaching Professor** in the Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

## Education

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**Purdue University**, West Lafayette, IN *2016 - 2024*  
PhD in Electrical and Computer Engineering  
Advisor: Prof. C. S. George Lee  
Thesis: “[Towards Manipulator Task-Oriented Programming: Automating Behavior-Tree Configuration](#),”

**Ohio State University**, Columbus, OH *2014 - 2016*  
M.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering

**Shanghai Jiao Tong University**, Shanghai, China *2011 - 2015*  
B.S. in Automation Engineering

## Publication

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**Yue Cao**, “GitHub Repository as Handbook, Jupyter Notebook as Report: A Format Redesign for the Electrical Engineering II Lab,” in *Proceedings of the Annual Conference and Exposition (Accepted)*, Charlotte, NC, 2026

**Yue Cao** and Jiamin Zhao, “Embedding Intelligence: Teaching Modern AI Implementation in a Raspberry Pi-Centric Laboratory Course,” in *Proceedings of the ASEE St. Lawrence Section Conference (Accepted)*, Ithaca, NY, 2026

**Yue Cao**, “[Large Language Models for Nodal Analysis in Circuits Education: An Evaluation](#),” in *Proceedings of the IEEE SoutheastCon*, Huntsville, AL, 2026

**Yue Cao**, “[Performance Evaluation of Whisper-Series Speech Transcription Models on Raspberry Pi](#),” in *Proceedings of the ACM/IEEE Symposium on Edge Computing – Edge Intelligence Workshop*, Arlington, VA, 2025

Yue Cao, “Performance Evaluation of Whisper-Series Speech Transcription Models on Raspberry Pi,” in *Proceedings of the ACM/IEEE Symposium on Edge Computing – Edge Intelligence Workshop*, Arlington, VA, 2023

Yue Cao and C. S. George Lee, “Ground Manipulator Primitive Tasks to Executable Actions using Large Language Models,” in *Proceedings of the AAAI Fall Symposium on Unifying Representations for Robot Application Development*, Arlington, VA, 2023

Yue Cao and C. S. George Lee, “Robot Behavior-Tree-Based Task Generation with Large Language Models,” in *Proceedings of the AAAI Spring Symposium on Challenges Requiring the Combination of Machine Learning and Knowledge Engineering (AAAI-MAKE)*, San Francisco, CA, 2023.

Yue Cao and C. S. George Lee, “Behavior-Tree Embeddings for Robot Task-Level Knowledge,” in *Proceedings of the IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)*, Kyoto, Japan, 2022.

Haoan Wang, Yue Cao, Bilin Aksun Güvenç, Levent Güvenç, “MPC Based Automated Steering of a Low Speed Shuttle for Socially Acceptable Accident Avoidance,” in *Proceedings of the ASME Dynamic Systems and Control Conference (DSCC)*, Minneapolis, MN, 2016.

## Teaching

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**Assistant Teaching Professor**, Syracuse University, NY

2024 - Present

Courses:

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|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| SCN 147 – EE I: Circuits and Robots (Pre-College) | 26                 |
| ELE 231 – Electrical Engineering Fundamentals     | 25F, 26F           |
| ELE 292 – Linear Systems Laboratory               | 24F, 25S, 25F, 26F |
| ELE 251 – Fundamentals of Linear Systems          | 25S                |
| CSE 398 – Embedded and Mobile Systems Laboratory  | 25S, 26S           |
| CSE 400 – Intelligent Robotics                    | 26S                |

Course Material Samples are available on:

<https://botyue.github.io/teaching.html>

**Instructor**, Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN

2016 - 2024

ECE 308 – Systems Simulation and Control Lab

Collaborate with **Prof. Shreyas Sundaram** to design curriculum.

**Purdue Magoon Excellence in Teaching Award**

2019

Selected by faculty and students to recognize graduate students who were exemplary in teaching.

**Purdue Teaching Academy Graduate Teaching Award**

2023

Selected by department from every 50 graduate teaching assistants.

## Presentation

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**Poster**, “Towards Manipulator Task-Oriented Programming: Automating Behavior-Tree Configuration”, at *the Northeast Robotics Colloquium (NERC)*, Ithaca, NY, 2025.

**Oral Presentation**, “Ground Manipulator Primitive Tasks to Executable Actions using Large Language Models”, as Late-Breaking Results at *the IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)*, Detroit, MI, 2023.

**Oral Presentation**, “Robot Behavior-Tree-Based Task Generation with Large Language Models”, at *the Purdue Robotics and Intelligent Systems Expo*, West Lafayette, IN, 2023.

## Service/Outreach

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>Department Committee</b> for Computer Science program ABET               | 2025-2026                   |
| <b>Booth Host</b> , Mircon Day at Syracuse University                       | 2026                        |
| <b>Event Coordinator</b> , Syracuse School District Vex Robotics Tournament | 2026                        |
| <b>Booth Host</b> , ECS College open house, ECS College showcase            | 2025-2026                   |
| <b>Judge</b> , <i>Purdue Undergraduate Research Conference</i>              | 2018, 2023                  |
| <b>Demo</b> , K-12 student outreach for Lego Robotics classes               | 2017 grant 2017, 2018, 2023 |

## Other Awards

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| “Shared Competencies” Assignment Design Award, Syracuse University Center for Teaching and Learning Excellence | 2026             |
| Summer Institute for Technology-Enhanced Teaching and Learning, Syracuse University ITS                        | 2026             |
| Course Redesign Institute, Syracuse University Center for Teaching and Learning Excellence                     | 2025             |
| Purdue College of Engineering graduate conference travel grant                                                 | 2023             |
| Purdue Graduate School summer research grant                                                                   | 2017, 2018, 2023 |

## Review

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>Reviewer</b> , <i>IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L)</i>                | 2026 |
| <b>Reviewer</b> , <i>IEEE Int. Conf. Tools with Artificial Intelligence (ICTAI)</i> | 2026 |
| <b>Reviewer</b> , <i>IEEE Int. Conf. Systems, Man, and Cybernetics (SMC)</i>        | 2026 |
| <b>Reviewer</b> , <i>IROS 2026</i>                                                  | 2026 |

**Reviewer**, *IROS 2025 Workshop on Embodied AI and Robotics for Future Scientific Discovery* 2025

**Reviewer**, *RSS 2024 Workshop on Task Specification for General-Purpose Intelligent Robots* 2024

**Reviewer**, *ACL Rolling Review* 2024

**Reviewer**, in the Young Reviewers Program of the *IEEE Robotics and Automation Society (RAS)* 2023 - present

**Reviewer**, *IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)* 2023

**Reviewer**, *IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L)* 2023

**Reviewer**, *IEEE-RAS International Conference on Humanoid Robots* 2023

## Professional Experience

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**Graduate Researcher**, Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN 2016 - 2024  
 with **Prof. C. S. George Lee**, at the Assistive Robotics Technology Laboratory  
 Focusing on utilizing the AI techniques to facilitate the intelligence of robot systems.  
 Researching on improving behavior-tree-based planning, including efficient task re-usage,  
 autonomous generation of hierarchical task.

Researching on robot planning-to-acting transition, including action grounding of manipulator primitive tasks and reinforcement learning within precedence-constrained tasks.

**Research Intern**, Bosch Research and Technology Center, Shanghai, China 2016  
 Surveyed on the real-time 3-D human motion tracking using inertial sensors.

**Graduate Researcher**, Ohio State University, Columbus, OH 2015 - 2016  
 with **Prof. Levent Güvenc**, at the Automated Driving Lab.  
 Developed an approach to generate vehicle simulation trajectories based on OpenStreetMap.  
 Investigated the realization of autonomous driving on Ford Fusion hybrid vehicles.

**Graduate Grader**, Ohio State University, Columbus, OH 2015  
 with **Prof. Yuan F. Zheng**  
 Course: ECE 5463 – Introduction to Real-Time Robotics Systems.

**Software Engineer Intern**, Honeywell Security Group, Shanghai, China 2015  
 Function test for the Honeywell video storage team.

**Undergraduate Researcher**, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, China  
 with **Prof. Ning Li**, at the Key Lab of System Control and Information Processing  
 Model predictive controller design for HVAC systems.